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MJE:C

May 2, 1973

Mr. Kingman Brewster, Jr.
President of Yale University
Woodbridge Hall
105 Wall Street
New Haven, Connecticut

Dear King:

Last week I had a visit from three Puerto Rican students at Yale. Their primary spokesman was Manuel del Valle '74 Law.

The thrust of their discussion was that Yale had a great potential to create the most distinguished Puerto Rican Studies Department in the United States, but that this potential was not being realized. The importance of such studies, they say, is emphasized by the facts, among others, that there are 12,000 Puerto Ricans in New Haven and 1,800,000 on the Eastern seaboard.

They propose the creation of a Puerto Rican Studies Department at Yale and discussed this with me in some detail. At the time they saw me their biggest concern was that they had been unable to discuss the matter with you, but I heard from them last Friday that they have an appointment to meet with you on May 9th.

I was favorably impressed by the enthusiasm and articulateness of their representation, and I am sure that you will be, too.

I told them that I would write you, adding that I didn't think it would influence you one way or the other, but I did say I was sure you would be sympathetic to their problem if they could get to meet with you. However, I pointed out that with the other demands on the University's facilities and finances, it may be very difficult to work out in whole or to any significant extent what they would like to see. They did seem to be willing to make substantial efforts themselves to seek funding from foundations, etc., for what they propose, and with their enthusiasm they might be able to do it. I suggested that possibly the University might be able to suggest some foundations, etc., that they might fruitfully approach.

COPY



Yale University

INTER-OFFICE CORRESPONDENCE

Date: April 7, 1972
To: Henry Chauncey, Jr.
From: Lawrence M. Noble, Jr. *Larry*
Subject: Puerto Rican Recruitment

*Secret to Mr. Brewster
Mr. Fauter
Mr. Taylor -*

RECEIVED
APR 17 1972
PRESIDENT'S OFFICE

You asked for a brief resume of the events leading up to the picketing of the Yale Club of New York City by Puerto Rican students on April 4.

Puerto Rican students from the mainland and from the island have been involved in our Minority Recruitment Program since its inception in September 1971. One Puerto Rican student from the island and one from the mainland served on the Supervisory Committee since that time. Hector Medina is the mainland Puerto Rican representative.

At the meeting on November 12, Hector brought up the issue of Eduardo Padro working in the Admissions Office as the Puerto Rican bursary student. Glenn deChabert explained to him that this was perfectly all right as long as he relinquished his long term loan, which he had opted for in place of a bursary job. DeChabert explained that a student cannot have both, when his financial need is being met with one or the other. Hector claimed that Padro needed the additional money, and deChabert asked Hector to ask Padro to come to the Financial Aid Office to discuss his financial resources and aid for the year.

The meeting on January 7, 1972 was the last to be attended by Hector Medina.

The February 9, 1972 edition of the Yale Daily News contained an open letter to President Brewster, signed by the "Executive Committee of Boricuas Unidos -- Hector Medina, 1973, Gilbert Casellas, 1974, Eduardo Padro, 1975, Cruz Ramos, 1975, Manuel del Valle y Colon, 1974L." Attached is a copy of this open letter and the related Daily News article.

A number of attempts have been made by various members of the Supervisory Committee to discuss the letter with Hector since

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Mr. Henry Chauncey, Jr.

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its publication: 1) Chauncey had previously scheduled a meeting with Medina to discuss recruitment in general and to ask for nominations from Medina for potential Puerto Rican members of the Admissions staff. Medina never showed up for this appointment. 2) Chauncey later saw Medina and asked him to schedule another appointment, since he (Chauncey) wanted to get together with him to discuss the above. Medina never called to make another appointment. 3) Noble sent a personal note to Medina inviting him to attend the February 17 Supervisory Committee meeting to discuss the open letter. Medina did not attend. 4) Bill Brown contacted Medina in Timothy Dwight to try to discuss the situation, but Medina was evasive and unwilling to discuss it. 5) Alberto Alvarado and Ken Ito have had several discussions with Medina on the campus, and Medina seems to show some inclination to continue working with other minority students, but probably not through the auspices of the Supervisory Committee.

Bill Brown indicated that Hector would accept only a letter from President Brewster or the Admissions Office, not from the Supervisory Committee. Subsequently, Ken Ito reported that he thought Hector would accept a letter from the Supervisory Committee. Alvarado and Ito were commissioned to write such a letter, the letter to be approved by the full Supervisory Committee before its mailing. Subsequently, they met with Hector and felt it would be better not to write a letter, but rather to continue discussions with Hector outside of the Supervisory Committee. This is where the matter stands at present.

In the meantime, Hector apparently took it upon himself to write to such organizations as the Puerto Rican Association for National Affairs in Washington, the Puerto Rican Research and Resources Center, Inc. in Washington, Congressman Herman Badillo, and a number of other individuals and organizations. These letters enclosed copies of the Yale Daily News open letter and other documents, and asked the recipients to help end Yale's discrimination against mainland Puerto Ricans. We have been receiving letters from a variety of these recipients, all of which have been answered either by President Brewster, Chauncey, or Noble.

Mr. Henry Chauncey, Jr.

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One of the people who telephoned was a Yale Law School graduate, Jose Cabranes. Details of this conversation are outlined in my memo of March 27 to you. Mr. Cabranes may well be an effective aid in our program to recruit and matriculate mainland Puerto Rican students.

LMN:ss

Enclosures: 2

Noble

From CEG

Latinos Refuse Recruiting Role

FEB 21 REC'D

By BEVERLY WAGSTAFF

Boricuas Unidos, a Puerto Rican student group at Yale, has charged the University with failure to commit itself in a meaningful way to the recruitment of Puerto Rican applicants.

In a public letter to Yale President Kingman Brewster, Jr., Boricuas Unidos announced its withdrawal from the Yale Minority Recruitment Committee until the University demonstrates a sincere willingness to actively recruit Puerto Ricans.

Matters came to a head for the Puerto Rican group when they found that "the so-called expanded recruitment effort is tailored to the needs of the Admissions Office without regard to the needs of the mainland Puerto Rican student."

Boricuas Unidos stated in its letter "the piecemeal recruitment effort envisioned by Yale College for next year is presently doomed to failure." (For the full text of the letter see page 2).

Henry Chauncey, Jr., secretary to the university, declined to comment on the complaints of Boricuas Unidos since its letter was not yet available to him.

Indicative of Yale's insensitivity to the needs of Puerto Rican students, according to Boricuas Unidos, was the failure of the administration to respond officially to a memorandum on the admission of Puerto Ricans which the group submitted in September to Charles Taylor, Yale provost, Chauncey, and John Muyskens, Jr., dean of undergraduate admissions.

12 Puerto Ricans At Yale

The report stated that while 1.4 million Puerto Ricans live within a 70 mile radius of Yale, only 12 are at present enrolled at Yale as undergraduates, and 17 in the University as a whole.

While Chicanos and Puerto Ricans are represented in comparable numbers in the U.S. population, there are some 65 undergraduate Chicanos at Yale.

Thus, says Boricuas Unidos, though "Yale has been successful in recruiting Black Americans and Mexican-Americans in the recent past, they have failed to do so for the mainland Puerto Rican."

The letter from the Puerto

Rican group goes further to point out what Boricuas Unidos feels are a series of rigid constraints set by the Admissions Office for recruitment procedure.

In addition, states the letter, some Puerto Rican applicants have been discouraged from applying on the basis of SAT and achievement scores.

Boricuas Unidos also notes there is no Puerto Rican representation on the Admissions Committee or among staffers who interview candidates for admission.

Testifying that Princeton has some 20 Puerto Rican undergraduates and Columbia has enrolled 46, Boricuas Unidos recommends that Yale commit itself to increased admissions of Puerto Ricans with the object of a Puerto Rican representation in the student body commensurate with that group's national representation.

Supervisory Committee

Yale created a Supervisory Committee this year made up of representatives from the four minority groups at Yale and certain university officials whose purpose is the development of an ongoing, comprehensive recruitment program. Apparently Boricuas Unidos does not believe the work of such a committee will have fruitful results.

There also exist four new bursary jobs at the Admissions Office, one for a member of each minority group, including the Puerto Rican.

Each student is responsible for the coordination of recruitment activities for his or her minority.

Despite these changes, students like Alberto Alvarado, 1973, a Chicano recruiter, assert "no great strides have been taken to help us in recruiting and assuring the matriculation of larger numbers of Latinos."

At Wesleyan, where 17 Puerto Ricans are enrolled in the freshman class of 440, one assistant dean of admissions focuses on minority recruitment alone.

"We develop a pool of Latin students and take the best applicants in the pool," said Randy Miller. "These students are competing against other Latino candidates, not against the larger applicant pool."

Yale Daily News
2/19/72

Open Letter to President Brewster

January 25, 1972, the Yale NEWS reported: "The recruitment program remained basically unchanged this year except for an expanded effort to recruit minority group members." Boricuas Unidos takes this opportunity to refute the implication of this article that this recruitment drive represents a sincere ongoing commitment for the recruitment of minority students—specifically, the mainland Puerto Rican. On September 27, 1971, Boricuas Unidos submitted a memorandum on "The Admission of Puerto Rican Students" to Yale's Provost Taylor, Secretary Chauncey, and Director of Admissions Muyskens. We have yet to receive any official reply from these gentlemen. The piecemeal recruitment effort envisioned by Yale College for the recruitment of Puerto Rican students to Yale for next year is presently doomed to failure. We have been led to believe that the Puerto Rican recruitment drive was to be formulated and planned by the Puerto Rican students themselves, but, in point of fact, the recruitment effort has been preplanned and is obstructed by bureaucratic delays. The so-called expanded recruitment effort is tailored to the needs of the admissions office without regard to the needs of the mainland Puerto Rican student.

Specifically, the constraints of time make it impossible for Boricuas Unidos to embark upon any immediate recruitment of students. As of January 31, 1972, no recruitment may be carried out unless five weeks ahead of time, the following information is submitted:

- (1) Names of recruiters
- (2) Date of departure and return
- (3) Names of all schools to be visited, what times, what dates, and which specific counselors will be met
- (4) Money requested for transportation

The purchase of all airline tickets will be done solely by the University; thus further delaying the process of recruitment. In short, this means that no one may recruit during the week of March 14 unless submitting the minority travel schedule by February 7.

Anyone familiar with the process of admission or recruitment, especially in New York City where 56 percent of the Puerto Rican population resides, would know that contacting counselors alone would take a minimum of two weeks. Furthermore, before meeting with any counselor, the principal of the school must be officially informed, thus delaying the process even more.

Additionally, scheduling in public schools in New York City is made difficult because most high schools with Puerto Rican populations run with double shifts. Thus the recruiter in any New York City school must conform to the scheduling and particular situation of the local school. The inflexibility of Yale's requirements for recruitment makes it impossible for us to launch any comprehensive recruitment effort evidencing a continued Yale commitment for the recruitment of Puerto Rican students. It is obvious, given the facts embodied in our memorandum which accompanies this statement, that the lack of an ongoing recruitment effort of Puerto Rican juniors and seniors will mean the nonadmission or nonrepresentation of Puerto Ricans to Yale College. Most important, however, no issue affects recruitment as much as the inflexibility of admissions criteria for Puerto Rican students.

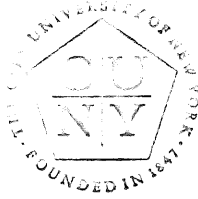
In our most recent recruitment, Puerto Rican applicants have been discouraged from applying solely on the basis of SAT scores. One candidate's counselor was told to discourage a particular Puerto Rican student from applying on the basis of his SAT scores despite the fact that he had a 90 average. While SATs may be an important indicator of academic success for the average Yale applicant, Fred E. Crossland, program officer for special projects in education for the Ford Foundation, indicates in the foundation's report entitled "Minority Access to College" that SATs alone are an unreliable measure of the student's actual potential.

This is particularly true with regard to the Puerto Rican who is both bilingual and bicultural and against whom more often

than not these types of exams discriminate. The lack of any Puerto Rican input, either through representation on the admissions committee or as readers of folders, or as candidate interviewers further obstructs the possibility that any number of Puerto Rican students will be admitted. Accordingly, Boricuas Unidos questions the extent of Yale's commitment to the mainland Puerto Rican student particularly with regard to the following areas:

- (1) The flexibility of admissions criteria which takes into account the bilingual and bicultural background of the Puerto Rican candidate.
 - (2) An ongoing comprehensive program as opposed to the current piecemeal program offered by the Yale admissions office.
 - (3) The immediate hiring of a Puerto Rican as an assistant dean of admissions at an adequate salary specifically in charge of recruitment in New York City.
 - (4) The hiring of Yale Puerto Rican graduate students to read mainland Puerto Rican applications to Yale College.
 - (5) The admission of Puerto Rican mainland students to Yale commensurate with their status as the second largest minority group in the Northeast.
 - (6) An official response from President Brewster regarding the memorandum submitted to Provost Taylor on September 27, 1971.
 - (7) The rejection of the present financial aid policy which prevents any student from taking out a federal loan while having a federally funded work-study job, thus preventing him from working in the New Haven community.
 - (8) The failure of Yale to recruit mainland Puerto Rican high school seniors from Catholic high schools.
 - (9) The referring of any Puerto Rican student coming onto the Yale campus to Boricuas Unidos.
- Until the University is willing to actively support the above stated objectives, Boricuas Unidos withdraws from the Yale Minority Recruitment Committee.

Executive Committee of
Boricuas Unidos
Hector Medina, 1973
Gilbert Casellas, 1974
Eduardo Padro, 1975
Cruz Ramos, 1975
Manuel del Valle y Colon, 1974L



Center for Puerto Rican Studies

535 East 80 Street, New York, N.Y. 10021

April 23, 1973

Dr. Kingman Brewster
President
Yale University
New Haven, Connecticut

Dear Dr. Brewster:

The Center for Puerto Rican Studies has been recently constituted at the City University. It is intended to serve as an instrument to help consolidate Puerto Rican studies as an academic resource for students and our community and as a field of productive scholarship within the University. Though the Center was created in response to felt needs in departments and programs within the City University, non CUNY students and faculty shared in the work of formulating plans for the Center and are now participating in the mounting of an organization and defining first activities. Yale students have been present at some of our meetings. They are keeping us abreast of their efforts to persuade Yale to seriously address the many problems and aspirations of Puerto Rican students and community there.

I have read carefully the Policy Statement on the Status of Puerto Ricans at Yale and will be sharing that material with students and faculty in the departments and programs the Center serves. The statement struck me as a sober assessment, thoughtful in its exposition of fact and moderate in its approach to solutions. It clearly builds on a sense of the unique opportunities present at Yale and an expectation that the institution will yet respond in terms of its own high ideals to the present challenge. The document is sure to evoke strong support from the Puerto Rican community. I personally urge that the proposal be given the serious consideration it certainly merits. The Center has assured the student group at Yale that we stand ready to help in any way we can in furthering their several projects.

Sincerely,

Frank Bonilla,
Director, Professor of Political Science

aj
cc. Wilfredo Martinez
Despierta Boricua

May 21, 1973

President Kingman Brewster
Yale University
Woodbridge Hall
105 Wall Street
New Haven, Conn. 06520

Dear Dr. Brewster:

I have been contacted by Mr. Eduardo Padro, Chairman of the student organization called Despierta Boricua. In his correspondence, he has indicated that the organization has requested that you implement a Puerto Rican Studies Dept. at Yale. I wish to add my voice of strong support in favor of such a project. Wherever it has been implemented - Brooklyn College, Hunter, Fordham and Livingston College, it has been a tremendous success and has broadened the educational perspectives for Puerto Rican students and very often of non-Puerto Rican students as well.

A second point is the students' request for a Puerto Rican Assistant Dean. Here too, our experience has been that the hiring of Puerto Rican faculty and staff has proven to be of immeasurable assistance to Puerto Rican students in their attempt to negotiate their education with the university.

I trust that you will accord full consideration to the students' request and respond to their needs to the utmost extent feasible. Should you or any member of your staff require any additional information or consultation, please do not hesitate to call on me.

Cordially,

Luis Nieves
Dean of Student Affairs

LN/m